

PLAYING SAFE



When people invest in shares or other financial products, they aim to make a profit. But markets are constantly changing, so the value of their investment can go down as well as up. Some others may choose to make less profit and opt for a safer investment, such as government bonds or bank savings accounts.

ECONOMIC FORECASTS



Many economic decisions involve predicting what will happen in the future, such as whether prices will rise or fall. Economists today use complex computer modeling and algorithms to make forecasts, but even these can't take into account natural uncertainty, such as the weather, and the fact that people behave unpredictably.

RISE AND FALL



While many poor countries struggle to survive, others are developing fast with unprecedented economic growth, and some older developed countries are even in decline. Nothing in economics is certain, and it may be that in 100 years' time new economic powers will have replaced the US, Europe, and Japan.